NEXUS PLANNING

South Marston, Swindon (Parcels R6 & R7)

Affordable Housing Statement

ON BEHALF OF VISTRY HOMES LIMITED

August 2024

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1. Introduction

1.1 This Affordable Housing Statement has been prepared on behalf of Vistry Homes Limited to support a reserved matters submission for 137 dwellings on Parcels R6 and R7 of the Rowborough and South Marston outline planning permission (S/OUT/13/1555ED SN), located within the Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner Character Area.

2. Context

Planning Policy

National Planning Policy Framework – December 2023 (NPPF)

2.1 Paragraph 64 of the NPPF confirms that, where a need for affordable housing is identified, planning policies should specify the type of affordable housing required. The various types of affordable housing that are available are defined in Annex 2 of the NPPF and comprise:

> *"a) Affordable housing for rent: meets all of the following conditions: (a) the rent is set in accordance with the Government's rent policy for Social Rent or Affordable Rent, or is at least 20% below local market rents (including service charges where applicable); (b) the landlord is a registered provider, except where it is included as part of a Build to Rent scheme (in which case the landlord need not be a registered provider); and (c) it includes provisions to remain at an affordable price for future eligible households, or for the subsidy to be recycled for alternative affordable housing provision. For Build to Rent schemes affordable housing for rent is expected to be the normal form of affordable housing provision (and, in this context, is known as Affordable Private Rent).*
>
> *b) Starter homes: is as specified in Sections 2 and 3 of the Housing and Planning Act 2016 and any secondary legislation made under these sections. The definition of a starter home should reflect the meaning set out in statute and any such secondary legislation at the time of plan-preparation or decision-making. Where secondary legislation has the effect of limiting a household's eligibility to purchase a starter home to those with a particular maximum level of household income, those restrictions should be used.*
>
> *c) Discounted market sales housing: is that sold at a discount of at least 20% below local market value. Eligibility is determined with regard to local incomes and local house prices. Provisions should be in place to ensure housing remains at a discount for future eligible households.*
>
> *d) Other affordable routes to home ownership: is housing provided for sale that provides a route to ownership for those who could not achieve home ownership through the market. It includes shared ownership, relevant equity loans, other low cost homes for sale (at a price equivalent to at least 20% below local market value) and rent to buy (which includes a period of intermediate rent). Where public grant funding is provided, there should be provisions for the homes to remain at an affordable price for future eligible households, or for any receipts to be recycled for alternative affordable housing provision, or refunded to Government or the relevant authority specified in the funding agreement."*

2.2 Paragraph 66 of the NPPF states that where major development involving the provision of housing is proposed, planning policies and decisions should expect at least 10% of the homes to be available for affordable home ownership, unless this would exceed the level of affordable housing required in the area, or significantly prejudice the ability to meet the identified affordable housing needs of specific groups.

Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026 (SBLP Adopted March 2015)

2.3 The site forms part of the **Policy NC3** New Eastern Villages strategic allocation within the Swindon Borough Local Plan 2026, which allocates land to the east of the A419, north and south of the A420, as a major mixed use urban extension comprising a series of inter-connected villages. South Marston is extended as part of the allocation. The policy makes provision for around 2,000 dwellings to the north of the A420 (at South Marston and Rowborough)

and around 6,000 dwellings south of the A420 within the new eastern Villages. The Policy requires that affordable housing is provided in accordance with the terms of Policy HA2 of the Local Plan.

2.4 **Policy HA2** requires that on all developments of 15 homes or more/sites larger than 0.5ha (subject to viability) that a target of 30% affordable housing provision should be achieved on site. Where this is achieved the housing should be integrated within the design and layout of the development with a mix and tenure that reflects current need.

2.5 The reserved matters submission is brought forward pursuant to the terms of outline planning permission S/OUT/13/1555ED SN, which is subject to the provisions of a S106 agreement that sets out the affordable housing requirements for the development. The obligations are set out below:

Table 1: S106 Provisions

Affordable Housing – Schedule 3	Requirement
Quantum	All reserved matters submissions must provide between 20% and 25% of proposed dwellings as affordable housing, with the site delivering 23% affordable housing overall (548 dwellings).
Tenure	50% affordable rented, 50% intermediate (shared ownership).
Mix and Size	15% - 1-bed flats (2 person) 53% - 2-bed flats and houses (majority houses) (4 person) 30% - 3-bed houses, including some ground floor level access flats (3-bed) (5 person) 2% - 4-Bed houses (7 person)
Distribution	Tenure blind and in clusters not exceeding 15 units, of which no more than 11 units for affordable rent.

3. Proposed Affordable Housing Provision

3.1 The proposed housing mix (market and affordable housing) is set out in Table 2 below:

Table 2: Proposed Quantum and Dwelling Mix

Parcel R6	Plots (No.)	Market	Affordable Rent	Shared Ownership
Block 1	1-13 (13)	2 x 3-bed	4 x 2-bed	NA
		7 x 4-bed		
Block 2	14-20 (7)	2 x 3-bed	NA	NA
		5 x 4-bed		
Block 3	21-61 (41)	2 x 2-bed	6 x 1-bed	NA
		18 x 3-bed		
		6 x 4-bed	4 x 2-bed	5 x 2-bed
Block 4	62-78 (17)	2 x 2-bed	NA	NA
		7 x 3-bed		
		8 x 4-bed		
Block 5	79-91 (13)	2 x 3-bed	NA	6 x 2-bed
		5 x 4-bed		
Block 6	92-106 (15)	9 x 3-bed	NA	NA
		6 x 4-bed		
Totals	**106**	**81**	**14**	**11**
Parcel R7	**Plots (No.)**	**Market**	**Affordable Rent**	**Shared Ownership**
Block 7	107-137 (31)	2 x 2-bed	NA	4 x 3-bed
		13 x 3-bed		
		12 x 4-bed		
Totals	**31**	**27**	**0**	**4**

3.2 As set out in the Table above, the proposals comprise 108 market dwellings (78.8%) and 29 affordable dwellings (21.2%) across parcels R6 and R7, which is in accordance with the requirement set out in Schedule 3, para. 1.1 of the S106 agreement to provide between 20% and 26% affordable housing within any sub-phase of development (sub-phase being defined in the S106 agreement as a single residential reserved matters submission).

3.3 The affordable housing units are designed and arranged in clusters that meet the requirements of the S106 agreement, which stipulates that affordable housing units should be tenure blind and in clusters not exceeding 15 units, of which no more than 11 units should be for affordable rent. Table 3 details the distribution and type of housing proposed:

Table 3: Affordable Dwelling Distribution

Parcel	Block	Plots	Cluster size	Affordable Rent	Shared Ownership
R6	1	5-8	4	4	0
	3	29-36, 41-47	15	10	5
	5	79-84	6	0	6
R7	7	113-116	4	0	4

3.4 The affordable units are designed to be indistinguishable from the market dwellings; the 2 and 3-bedroom affordable houses being the Cooper and Asher house types, which are utilised within the market mix of dwellings. The 1-bedroom affordable maisonettes are designed to be indistinguishable from the market dwellings adjacent to and opposite within Parcel R6. The dwellings have levels of external amenity space, privacy, and car parking that are commensurate with the equivalent market dwellings (by size and type) and are constructed from a palette of materials that is consistent with the type and quality used for the market dwellings.

3.5 The S106 agreement prescribes a tenure mix of affordable dwellings that is to apply to the affordable component of the whole development, subject to the outline permission for 2,380 dwellings (548 dwellings).

3.6 The apportionment as set out below:

Table 4: Affordable Dwelling Mix (S106)

Type	Persons	OPP number (%)	R6/R7 number (%)
1-bed flats	2	82 (15)	6 (21)
2-bed flats/houses	4	290 (53)	19 (65)
3-bed houses (including some level access 3-bed flats)	5	165 (30)	4 (14)
4-bed houses	7	11 (2)	0 (0)

3.7 The provisions of the S106 agreement are not prescriptive for individual reserve matters submissions and therefore a compliance requirement does not exist for specific parcels. Vistry will meet the overall affordable housing mix and

distribution requirements set out in the S106 agreement for the reserve matter submissions that will relate to their land interests within the outline permission and will deliver a S106 compliant type/tenure/distribution/quantum to achieve 23% affordable housing delivery.

Figure 1: Parcel Plan (with Affordable Housing Distribution)

3.8 Figure 1, above, reproduces the parcel plan denoting the proposed block structure and showing the proposed distribution of affordable housing units.

4. Conclusion

4.1 The reserved matters submission for Parcels R6 and R7 of the Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner Character Area has been prepared in accordance with the obligations set out in the Section 106 Agreement dated 11 August 2021.

4.2 The reserve matters application comprises 137 dwellings of which 29 are provided as affordable dwellings (21.2%) across parcels R6 and R7. The level of provision is within the parameters set by Schedule 3 para.1.1 of the S106 agreement, which requires that between 20% and 26% of dwellings within any sub-phase of development (sub-phase being defined in the S106 agreement as a single residential reserved matters submission) should be provided as affordable housing.

4.3 The proposed tenure split comprises 14 dwellings for affordable rent and (48%) and 15 for shared ownership (52%), which is closely in accordance with the site wide requirement set out in Schedule 3, para. 1.1 of the S106 agreement to provide an even split between affordable rented and shared ownership accommodation. As noted, the S106 agreement is not prescriptive at the sub-phase (individual reserved matter application) level in this regard, the proposed tenure split is therefore in accordance with the requirements of the planning permission.